

CORPORATE NEWS snippets

Bharti Global and OneWeb Launch 36 communication satellites

Bharti Global and the UK government-led OneWeb have launched 36 communication satellites. The duo aims to offer high-speed internet from its constellation of satellites in India by mid-2022. This was OneWeb's third launch in 2020. It has brought the total in-orbit constellation to 110 satellites, part of OneWeb's 648 LEO fleet designed to deliver high-speed, low-latency global connectivity.

Ola to set up EV manufacturing plant in Tamil Nadu

Ola has signed an MoU with the Tamil Nadu government for an investment of 24 billion rupees in setting up its first EV manufacturing factory in the state. Upon completion, the factory will create almost 10,000 jobs and initially have an annual capacity of two million units. The factory will produce Ola's upcoming range of two-wheeler products, starting with Ola's electric scooter.

Honeywell makes investment in Bengaluru-based Trinity Mobility

Honeywell has announced a strategic investment in Trinity Mobility Private Limited, a Bengaluru software company and provider of the leading Internet of Things (IoT) smart cities platform and software applications. This strategic investment will allow it to expand its smart cities capabilities by providing access to Trinity's smart city solutions. This strategic investment, which is structured to provide Honeywell with a path to full ownership of Trinity, will allow Honeywell to more fully partner with cities that are expanding their smart city deployments or integrating new systems.

Intel sells power management chip business to MediaTek

Taiwan-based chip manufacturer MediaTek has acquired Intel's power management chip business, Enpirion. The deal, estimated to be worth \$85 million, was done through MediaTek's subsidiary Richtek. Famous for chips used in smartphones, MediaTek might be eyeing an expansion of its integrated power solutions used in FPGA, CPU, SoC, and ASIC.

Samsung planning to develop 3nm silicon semiconductor chips

Samsung is gearing up for semiconductor wars with a humongous \$116 billion budget. The company has allocated this budget to be used in the next two years specifically for the development of 3nm silicon semiconductor chips. It is worth mentioning here that the only 5nm chip available in the world right now, capable of powering an entire laptop, comes from the house of Apple's ARM.

HMD Global planning to make India its sourcing hub

HMD Global, the maker of Nokia mobile handsets, will be making India its prominent sourcing hub for global markets. It is presently working on building capabilities for smartphone manufacturing. HMD had recently raised \$250 million from investors like Nokia Technologies, Google, and Qualcomm.

STMicro optimises ToF sensors for complex imaging applications

STMicroelectronics has optimised FlightSense, a powerful and accurate time-of-flight (ToF) sensor. The company's perspective

and future goals were recently shared by Jerry Chang, technical marketing manager, Imaging Division, Greater China & South Asia, and Vincent Lin, technical marketing manager, Imaging Division, Greater China & South Asia. FlightSense is based on a laser emitter that transmits light or photons, which bounce back after colliding with the target and are taken in by the receiver. It gives exact distance, irrespective of colour, size, or reflectance of the object.

Tata Sons seeks funding for phone and components manufacturing

Tata Sons is looking to secure \$750 million to \$1 billion in external commercial borrowings and mobilise the remaining sum through internal accruals to set up a mobile phone and component manufacturing plant in Tamil Nadu to make iPhone parts. Tamil Nadu government had recently announced the Tamil Nadu Electronics Hardware Manufacturing Policy 2020. It aims to increase electronics industry output to \$100 billion by 2025 with the state contributing 25 per cent of India's total electronic exports by that year.

Lion Electric to go public through SPAC deal

Lion Electric Co. is going public through a merger with blank-check company Northern Genesis Acquisition Corp. It aims to ramp up production capacity to tap growing demand for electric vehicles. It expects to receive about \$500 million of net cash proceeds from the deal to expand its US manufacturing capacity, develop advanced battery systems, and construct a battery-system assembly factory.

Okaya bags contract from EESL for EV charging stations

Okaya Power Group firm Okaya has bagged a World Bank-funded contract from state-run Energy Efficiency Services Limited (EESL) for the deployment of 1,020 EV charging stations with CCS, CHAdeMO, and Bharat specification protocol across India. In September, it announced its partnership with BluSmart Electric Mobility startup for transportation solutions using electric vehicles. Okaya will be providing electric vehicle charging stations infrastructure for BluSmart's fleet operations as well.

Coal India to invest in solar projects

Coal India will invest 56.5 billion rupees (\$763 million) by March 2024 to build 14 solar projects to power its mining operations and cut costs. It will spend nearly two-thirds to construct rooftop and ground-mounted solar power projects with a capacity of 3,000 megawatts (MW) with cash. A joint venture with lignite miner NLC India would finance the rest of the company's solar expansion. Coal India has also signed an agreement with Solar Energy Corporation of India for 1,000MW solar projects.

L&T Technology selected for Alexa integration in devices

L&T Technology Services Limited (LTTS) has been selected as a consulting and professional services provider to support Alexa Voice Service (AVS) integration in various connected devices. Alexa, the Amazon cloud-based voice service, is available on devices from both Amazon and third-party manufacturers and powers connected devices. "We are delighted to see LTTS use their expertise in the consumer and industrial market, product development, device testing and certification, and innovation to transform their clients' customer experience," said Eric King, general manager, Amazon Alexa Europe.